

GCSE ENGLISH LITERATURE

POETRY ANTHOLOGY (C720)

For first assessment from 2027

The WJEC Eduqas GCSE (9-1) English Literature Poetry Anthology should be used to prepare for Component 1: Section B.

This version of the anthology is for first assessment from 2027.

GCSE ENGLISH LITERATURE for first assessment in 2027

Acknowledgements

WJEC Eduqas GCSE (9-1) English Literature Poetry Anthology

Published with support from WJEC's Teaching and Learning Resources Scheme

Published in 2024 by WJEC, 245 Western Avenue, Cardiff, CF5 2YX

© WJEC 2024

All rights reserved. No part of this book may be reprinted, reproduced or utilised in any form or by any electronic, mechanical, or other means, now known or hereafter invented, including photocopying and recording, or in any information storage and retrieval system, without permission in writing from the publishers.

ISBN: 978-1-86085-774-4

Printed by: WJEC CBAC Ltd

Every effort has been made to contact copyright holders of material reproduced in this book. If notified, the publishers will be pleased to rectify any errors or omissions at the earliest opportunity.

Poetry Anthology

This material has been endorsed by WJEC and offers high quality support for the delivery of Eduqas qualifications.

This resource supports the teaching and learning of WJEC Eduqas GCSE (9-1) English Literature Poetry Anthology.

Poetry and photo acknowledgements

Cover image: Brooke Anderson Photography / Moment / Getty Images;

P.4 “Schoolboy” by William Blake (1827) / Public Domain; p.5 “I Wander Lonely” by William Wordsworth (1850) / Public Domain; p.6 “Cousin Kate” by Christina Rossetti (1894) / Public Domain; p.8 “Sonnet 29” by E Barrett Browning (1861) / Public Domain;

p.9 “Drummer Hodge” by Thomas Hardy (1928) / Public Domain; p.10 “Disabled” by Wilfred Owen (1918) / Public Domain; p.12 “I Shall Return” by Claude McKay (1948)

/ Public Domain; p. 13 “Decomposition” by © Zulfikar Ghose 1967. Reproduced by permission of Sheil Land Associates.; p. 14 “Catrin” by Gillian Clarke reprinted with permission from Y Lolfa; p. 15 “Blackberry Picking” by Seamus Heaney published in 100 Poems by Seamus Heaney (Faber and Faber Ltd, 2022) , reprinted with permission from publisher, Faber and Faber Ltd; p. 16 “Kamikaze” by

GCSE ENGLISH LITERATURE for first assessment in 2027

Beatrice Garland, reprinted with permission from author; p.18 ‘War Photographer’ from Standing Female Nude

by Carol Ann Duffy. Published by Carcanet Press, 1985. Copyright© Carol Ann Duffy. Reproduced by permission of the author c/o Rogers, Coleridge & White Ltd., 20 Powis Mews, London W11 1JN; p.19 “Dusting The Phone” by Jackie Kay published in Darling: New & Selected Poems (Bloodaxe Books, 2007), reprinted by permission the publisher, Bloodaxe Books; p.20 “Remains” by Simon Armitage published in The Not Dead (Pomona Books, 2008), reprinted by permission the author c/o Morgan Green Creatives Ltd; p.21 “Origin Story” by Eve L. Ewing published in Electric Arches (Haymarket Books, 2017), reprinted by permission the publisher, Haymarket Books;

Poetry Anthology

Contents

The Schoolboy	4
I Wandered Lonely as a Cloud	5
Cousin Kate	6
Sonnet 29	8
Drummer Hodge	9
Disabled	10
I Shall Return	12
Decomposition	13
Catrin	14
Blackberry Picking	15
Kamikaze	16
War Photographer	18
Dusting the Phone	19
Remains	20
Origin Story	21

GCSE ENGLISH LITERATURE for first assessment in 2027

The Schoolboy

**I love to rise in a summer morn,
When the birds sing on every tree;
The distant huntsman winds his horn,
And the sky-lark sings with me.
O! what sweet company.**

**But to go to school in a summer morn,
O! it drives all joy away;
Under a cruel eye outworn.
The little ones spend the day.
In sighing and dismay.**

**Ah! then at times I drooping sit,
And spend many an anxious hour,
Nor in my book can I take delight,
Nor sit in learnings bower,
Worn thro' with the dreary shower.**

Poetry Anthology

How can the bird that is born for joy,
Sit in a cage and sing.

How can a child when fears annoy.
But droop his tender wing.
And forget his youthful spring.

O! father & mother, if buds are nip'd,
And blossoms blown away.
And if the tender plants are strip'd
Of their joy in the springing day.
By sorrow and care's dismay.

How shall the summer arise in joy.
Or the summer fruits appear.
Or how shall we gather what griefs destroy
Or bless the mellowing year.
When the blasts of winter appear.

William Blake

GCSE ENGLISH LITERATURE for first assessment in 2027

I Wandered Lonely as a Cloud

**I wandered lonely as a cloud
That floats on high o'er vales and hills,
When all at once I saw a crowd,
A host, of golden daffodils;
Beside the lake, beneath the trees,
Fluttering and dancing in the breeze.**

**Continuous as the stars that shine
And twinkle on the milky way,
They stretched in never-ending line
Along the margin of a bay:
Ten thousand saw I at a glance,
Tossing their heads in sprightly dance.**

Poetry Anthology

The waves beside them danced; but they
Out-did the sparkling waves in glee:
A poet could not but be gay,
In such a jocund company:
I gazed—and gazed—but little thought
What wealth the show to me had brought:

For oft, when on my couch I lie
In vacant or in pensive mood,
They flash upon that inward eye
Which is the bliss of solitude;
And then my heart with pleasure fills,
And dances with the daffodils.

William Wordsworth

GCSE ENGLISH LITERATURE for first assessment in 2027

Cousin Kate

**I was a cottage maiden
Hardened by sun and air,
Contented with my cottage mates,
Not mindful I was fair.
Why did a great lord find me out,
And praise my flaxen hair?
Why did a great lord find me out
To fill my heart with care?**

**He lured me to his palace home—
Woe's me for joy thereof—
To lead a shameless shameful life,
His plaything and his love.
He wore me like a silken knot,
He changed me like a glove;
So now I moan, an unclean thing,
Who might have been a dove.**

Poetry Anthology

O Lady Kate, my cousin Kate,
You grew more fair than I:
He saw you at your father's gate,
Chose you, and cast me by.
He watched your steps along the lane,
Your work among the rye;
He lifted you from mean estate
To sit with him on high.

Because you were so good and pure
He bound you with his ring:
The neighbours call you good and pure,
Call me an outcast thing.
Even so I sit and howl in dust,
You sit in gold and sing:
Now which of us has tenderer heart?
You had the stronger wing.

GCSE ENGLISH LITERATURE for first assessment in 2027

**O cousin Kate, my love was true,
Your love was writ in sand:
If he had fooled not me but you,
If you stood where I stand,
He'd not have won me with his love
Nor bought me with his land;
I would have spit into his face
And not have taken his hand.**

**Yet I've a gift you have not got,
And seem not like to get:
For all your clothes and wedding-ring
I've little doubt you fret.
My fair-haired son, my shame, my pride,
Cling closer, closer yet:
Your father would give lands for one
To wear his coronet.**

Christina Rossetti

Poetry Anthology

Sonnet 29

I think of thee!—my thoughts do twine and bud
About thee, as wild vines, about a tree,
Put out broad leaves, and soon there's nought to
see
Except the straggling green which hides the wood.
Yet, O my palm-tree, be it understood
I will not have my thoughts instead of thee
Who art dearer, better! Rather, instantly
Renew thy presence; as a strong tree should,
Rustle thy boughs and set thy trunk all bare,
And let these bands of greenery which insphere
thee
Drop heavily down,—burst, shattered, everywhere!
Because, in this deep joy to see and hear thee
And breathe within thy shadow a new air, I do not
think of thee—I am too near thee.

Elizabeth Barrett Browning

Drummer Hodge

**They throw in Drummer Hodge, to rest
Uncoffined — just as found:
His landmark is a kopje-crest
That breaks the veldt around:
And foreign constellations west
Each night above his mound.**

**Young Hodge the drummer never knew —
Fresh from his Wessex home —
The meaning of the broad Karoo,
The Bush, the dusty loam,
And why uprose to nightly view
Strange stars amid the gloam.**

Poetry Anthology

**Yet portion of that unknown plain
Will Hodge for ever be;
His homely Northern breast and brain
Grow up some Southern tree,
And strange-eyed constellations reign
His stars eternally.**

Thomas Hardy

GCSE ENGLISH LITERATURE for first assessment in 2027

Disabled

**He sat in a wheeled chair, waiting for dark,
And shivered in his ghastly suit of grey,
Legless, sewn short at elbow. Through the park
Voices of boys rang saddening like a hymn,
Voices of play and pleasure after day,
Till gathering sleep had mothered them from him.**

**About this time Town used to swing so gay
When glow-lamps budded in the light-blue trees
And girls glanced lovelier as the air grew dim,
—In the old times, before he threw away his knees.
Now he will never feel again how slim
Girls' waists are, or how warm their subtle hands,
All of them touch him like some queer disease.**

**There was an artist silly for his face,
For it was younger than his youth, last year.
Now he is old; his back will never brace;
He's lost his colour very far from here,**

Poetry Anthology

Poured it down shell-holes till the veins ran dry,
And half his lifetime lapsed in the hot race,
And leap of purple spurted from his thigh.
One time he liked a bloodsmear down his leg,
After the matches carried shoulder-high.
It was after football, when he'd drunk a peg,
He thought he'd better join. He wonders why ...
Someone had said he'd look a god in kilts.

That's why; and maybe, too, to please his Meg,
Aye, that was it, to please the giddy jilts,
He asked to join. He didn't have to beg;
Smiling they wrote his lie; aged nineteen years.
Germans he scarcely thought of; and no fears
Of Fear came yet. He thought of jewelled hilts
For daggers in plaid socks; of smart salutes;
And care of arms; and leave; and pay arrears;
Esprit de corps; and hints for young recruits.
And soon, he was drafted out with drums and
cheers.
Some cheered him home, but not as crowds cheer
Goal.
Only a solemn man who brought him fruits

GCSE ENGLISH LITERATURE for first assessment in 2027

Thanked him; and then inquired about his soul.

**Now, he will spend a few sick years in Institutes,
And do what things the rules consider wise,
And take whatever pity they may dole.**

**To-night he noticed how the women's eyes
Passed from him to the strong men that were whole.
How cold and late it is! Why don't they come
And put him into bed? Why don't they come?**

Wilfred Owen

Poetry Anthology

I Shall Return

**I shall return again; I shall return
To laugh and love and watch with wonder-eyes
At golden noon the forest fires burn,
Wafting their blue-black smoke to sapphire skies.
I shall return to loiter by the streams
That bathe the brown blades of the bending grasses,
And realize once more my thousand dreams
Of waters rushing down the mountain passes.
I shall return to hear the fiddle and fife
Of village dances, dear delicious tunes
That stir the hidden depths of native life,
Stray melodies of dim remembered runes.
I shall return, I shall return again,
To ease my mind of long, long years of pain.**

Claude McKay

Decomposition

**I have a picture I took in Bombay
of a beggar asleep on the pavement:
grey-haired, wearing shorts and a dirty shirt,
his shadow thrown aside like a blanket.
His arms and legs could be cracks in the stone,
routes for the ants' journeys, the flies' descents,
Brain-washed by the sun into exhaustion,
he lies veined into stone, a fossil man.
Behind him there is a crowd passingly
bemused by a pavement trickster and quite
indifferent to this very common sight
of an old man asleep on the pavement.
I thought it then a good composition
and glibly called it "The Man in the Street,"
remarking how typical it was of
India that the man in the street lived there.
His head in the posture of one weeping
into a pillow chides me now for my**

Poetry Anthology

**presumption at attempting to compose
art of his hunger and solitude.**

Zulfikar Ghose

GCSE ENGLISH LITERATURE for first assessment in 2027

Catrin

**I can remember you, child,
As I stood in a hot, white
Room at the window watching
The people and cars taking
Turn at the traffic lights.
I can remember you, our first
Fierce confrontation, the tight
Red rope of love which we both
Fought over. It was a square
Environmental blank, disinfected
Of paintings or toys. I wrote
All over the walls with my
Words, coloured the clean squares
With the wild, tender circles
Of our struggle to become
Separate. We want, we shouted,
To be two, to be ourselves.**

Poetry Anthology

Neither won nor lost the struggle
In the glass tank clouded with feelings
Which changed us both. Still I am fighting
You off, as you stand there
With your straight, strong, long
Brown hair and your rosy,
Defiant glare, bringing up
From the heart's pool that old rope,
Tightening about my life,
Trailing love and conflict,
As you ask may you skate
In the dark, for one more hour.

Gillian Clarke

Blackberry Picking

**Late August, given heavy rain and sun
For a full week, the blackberries would ripen.
At first, just one, a glossy purple clot
Among others, red, green, hard as a knot.
You ate that first one and its flesh was sweet
Like thickened wine: summer's blood was in it
Leaving stains upon the tongue and lust for
Picking. Then red ones inked up and that hunger
Sent us out with milk cans, pea tins, jam-pots
Where briars scratched and wet grass bleached our
boots.
Round hayfields, cornfields and potato-drills
We trekked and picked until the cans were full,
Until the tinkling bottom had been covered
With green ones, and on top big dark blobs burned
Like a plate of eyes. Our hands were peppered
With thorn pricks, our palms sticky as Bluebeard's.

We hoarded the fresh berries in the byre.**

Poetry Anthology

But when the bath was filled we found a fur,
A rat-grey fungus, glutting on our cache.
The juice was stinking too. Once off the bush
The fruit fermented, the sweet flesh would turn sour.
I always felt like crying. It wasn't fair
That all the lovely canfuls smelt of rot.
Each year I hoped they'd keep, knew they would not.

Seamus Heaney

GCSE ENGLISH LITERATURE for first assessment in 2027

Kamikaze

**Her father embarked at sunrise
with a flask of water, a samurai sword
in the cockpit, a shaven head
full of powerful incantations
and enough fuel for a one-way
journey into history**

**but half way there, she thought,
recounting it later to her children,
he must have looked far down
at the little fishing boats
strung out like bunting
on a green-blue translucent sea**

**and beneath them, arcing in swathes
like a huge flag waved first one way
then the other in a figure of eight,
the dark shoals of fishes
flashing silver as their bellies**

Poetry Anthology

swivelled towards the sun

and remembered how he
and his brothers waiting on the shore
built cairns of pearl-grey pebbles
to see whose withstood longest
the turbulent inrush of breakers
bringing their father's boat safe

– yes, grandfather's boat – safe
to the shore, salt-sodden, awash
with cloud-marked mackerel,
black crabs, feathery prawns,
the loose silver of whitebait and once
a tuna, the dark prince, muscular, dangerous.

And though he came back
my mother never spoke again
in his presence, nor did she meet his eyes
and the neighbours too, they treated him
as though he no longer existed,
only we children still chattered and laughed

GCSE ENGLISH LITERATURE for first assessment in 2027

till gradually we too learned
to be silent, to live as though
he had never returned, that this
was no longer the father we loved.
And sometimes, she said, he must have wondered
which had been the better way to die.

Beatrice Garland

Poetry Anthology

War Photographer

In his dark room he is finally alone
with spools of suffering set out in ordered rows.
The only light is red and softly glows,
as though this were a church and he
a priest preparing to intone a Mass.
Belfast. Beirut. Phnom Penh. All flesh is grass.

He has a job to do. Solutions slop in trays
beneath his hands, which did not tremble then
though seem to now. Rural England. Home again
to ordinary pain which simple weather can dispel,
to fields which don't explode beneath the feet
of running children in a nightmare heat.

Something is happening. A stranger's features
faintly start to twist before his eyes,
a half-formed ghost. He remembers the cries
of this man's wife, how he sought approval
without words to do what someone must
and how the blood stained into foreign dust.

GCSE ENGLISH LITERATURE for first assessment in 2027

**A hundred agonies in black and white
from which his editor will pick out five or six
for Sunday's supplement. The reader's eyeballs
prick
with tears between the bath and pre-lunch beers.
From the aeroplane he stares impassively at where
he earns his living and they do not care.**

Carol Ann Duffy

Poetry Anthology

Dusting the Phone

I am spending my time imagining the worst that could happen.

I know this is not a good idea, and that being in love, I could be

spending my time going over the best that has been happening.

The phone rings heralding some disaster. Sirens.

Or it doesn't ring which also means disaster. Sirens.

In which case, who would ring me to tell? Nobody knows.

The future is a long gloved hand. An empty cup.

A marriage. A full house. One night per week in stranger's white sheets. Forget tomorrow,

You say, don't mention love. I try. It doesn't work.

I assault the postman for a letter. I look for flowers.

I go over and over our times together, re-read them.

GCSE ENGLISH LITERATURE for first assessment in 2027

This very second I am waiting on the phone.

Silver service. I polish it. I dress for it.

I'll give it extra in return for your call.

**Infuriatingly, it sends me hoaxes, wrong numbers;
or worse, calls from boring people. Your voice
disappears into my lonely cotton sheets.**

I am trapped in it. I can't move. I want you.

All the time. This is awful – only a photo.

Come on, damn you, ring me. Or else. What?

I don't know what.

Jackie Kay

Poetry Anthology

Remains

On another occasion, we got sent out
to tackle looters raiding a bank.

And one of them legs it up the road,
probably armed, possibly not.

Well myself and somebody else and somebody else
are all of the same mind,
so all three of us open fire.

Three of a kind all letting fly, and I swear

I see every round as it rips through his life –

I see broad daylight on the other side.

So we've hit this looter a dozen times

and he's there on the ground, sort of inside out,

pain itself, the image of agony.

One of my mates goes by

and tosses his guts back into his body.

Then he's carted off in the back of a lorry.

GCSE ENGLISH LITERATURE for first assessment in 2027

End of story, except not really.

His blood-shadow stays on the street, and out on patrol

I walk right over it week after week.

Then I'm home on leave. But I blink

and he bursts again through the doors of the bank.

Sleep, and he's probably armed, and possibly not.

Dream, and he's torn apart by a dozen rounds.

And the drink and the drugs won't flush him out –

he's here in my head when I close my eyes,

dug in behind enemy lines,

not left for dead in some distant, sun-stunned,

sand-smothered land

or six-feet-under in desert sand,

but near to the knuckle, here and now,

his bloody life in my bloody hands.

Simon Armitage

Poetry Anthology

Origin Story

This is true:

my mother and my father
met at the Greyhound bus station
in the mid-eighties in Chicago.
my mother, all thick glass and afro puff,
came west on the train when she was nineteen,
lived in a friend's house and cared for her children,
played tambourine in a Chaka Khan cover band.
my father, all sleeveless and soft eye,
ran away from home when he was seventeen,
mimeographed communist newspapers
and drew comic books
like this one, for sale. one dollar.
my mother bought one.

love is like a comic book. it's fragile
and the best we can do is protect it
in whatever clumsy ways we can:
plastic and cardboard, dark rooms
and boxes. in this way, something

GCSE ENGLISH LITERATURE for first assessment in 2027

**never meant to last
might find its way to another decade,
another home, an attic, a basement, intact.
love is paper.
and if my parents' love was a comic book,
it never saw polyvinyl, never felt a backing.
it was curled into a back pocket for a day at the
park,
lent to a friend, read under covers,
reread hanging upside-down over the back of the
couch,
memorized, mishandled, worn thin, staples rusted.
a love like that doesn't last
but it has a good ending.**

Eve L Ewing